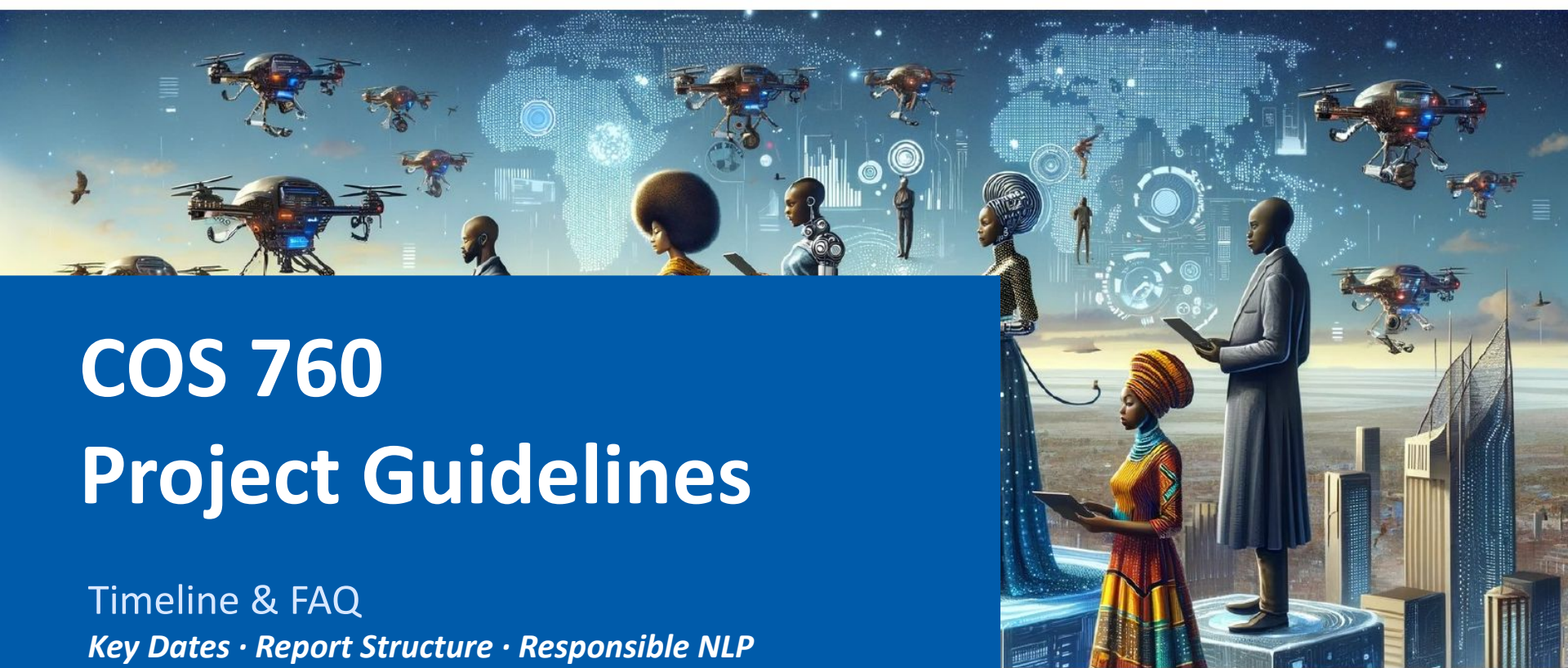




COS 760

Project Guidelines

Timeline & FAQ

Key Dates · Report Structure · Responsible NLP

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Project Timeline



Assessment: Projects will be assessed through both technical evaluation and self, peer, and group evaluation to account for collaborative contributions. Full rubric details will be communicated in due course.

Next Steps

01

Attend Class — 24 March

Full project details and templates will be reviewed. Attendance is essential.

02

Form Your Teams Now

Teams of exactly three members. Register by Friday, 20 March to avoid last-minute issues.

03

Review Project Templates

Templates are available from 17 March. Choose carefully — your proposal will build on your selected template.

04

Submit Bid by 25 March

Indicate your project preference during the bidding window (17–25 March). Allocations announced 27 March.

Report Structure

Your final report should follow a standard NLP research paper structure.

Introduction

- 1 State the problem, its importance for African or low-resource languages, objectives, contributions, and ethical motivation.

Background

- 2 Summarise related work, define key concepts, identify gaps in prior research, especially for African languages.

Methodology

- 3 Describe data sources, preprocessing, model choices, training setup, evaluation metrics, and justify key decisions.

Experiments & Results

- 4 Present quantitative results with tables and figures, include baselines, and provide qualitative error analysis.

Reflections

- 5 Discuss what worked, challenges faced, responsible AI principles, fairness, limitations, and societal impacts.

Conclusion

- 6 Summarise key findings, restate lessons learned, and mention open questions or areas for future work.

Responsible NLP Reflections

Throughout your report, demonstrate that you have considered the following:

Language Diversity

Are you addressing underrepresentation or fairness challenges in African or low-resource languages?

Equity & Bias

Did your models perform equally across languages? What do errors reveal about system limitations?

Data Ethics

Where did your data come from? Are there licensing, privacy, or ethical considerations to disclose?

Societal Impact

What are the real-world implications of your system? Who benefits, and who might be affected adversely?

Even brief reflections on these issues demonstrate responsible AI thinking — important both academically and professionally.

General Report Reminders

Writing Clarity

Prioritise clear, precise language over technical jargon. Your reader should understand your reasoning without difficulty.

Figures and Tables

Ensure all figures and tables are easy to read and are explicitly referenced in the text. Label everything clearly.

References

Use a consistent citation style (ACL recommended). Include all papers, datasets, models, code libraries, pretrained models, and open resources used.

Content Mark

The report is part of your Content Mark for the project. Quality of writing and depth of reflection both count.

Do We Have to Answer All the Suggested Research Questions?

No — you do not need to answer all of the suggested research questions.

The list of questions provided is intended to inspire your thinking and help you define a focused, tractable problem. Choose one or two questions that are:

- Genuinely interesting to your team.
- Manageable within the available time — you will have only a few weeks for the full project.
- Amenable to a concrete, well-justified methodology.

Your proposal should include a clear statement of the chosen question(s), your reasoning for selecting them, and the methods or tools you will use.

Tip: Keep your scope realistic. We are more interested in how well you design and justify your approach than in how ambitious your research question is.

Can We Include a High-Resource Language in Our Project?

Yes — you may include a high-resource language such as English in your project.

When it is acceptable

Using a high-resource language to build or validate a pipeline is acceptable — particularly during prototyping or early development stages.

What is required

Your proposal must demonstrate how your approach will apply to at least one low-resource African language. Core experiments and insights must target an underrepresented African language.

Tip: The goal of this project is to explore challenges and innovations in African language NLP. Your methodology should ultimately be tested on an African language that is underrepresented in existing tools and datasets.

Stay on Track

& Good Luck with the Project.

- Attend class on 24 March for full details.
- Register your team of three by 20 March.
- Submit your project bid by 25 March.
- Do not hesitate to ask questions.



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